

1. WHEN NARRATIVE BECOMES NON LINEAR

- Linearity breaks: Communal tales fixed into heroic scripts—now we remix via art's open fields.
- Agency over authorship: Instructions invite chance; viewers weave non-linear narratives, defying stable truths.

3. WHEN NARRATIVE BECOMES PLAYABLE

- Stories emerge through rules, actions, and consequences. The player's decisions generate the narrative.
- What happens when the systems we think we're just "using" turn out to be shaping us in return? Why does interactivity always carry a hidden architecture of control?

2. WHEN NARRATIVE BECOMES NETWORKED

- Stories are no longer contained inside one work. They unfold through links, databases, and navigation across information.
- What happens when the interfaces we think we're just browsing start to shape how we see, think, and move through the world? Why is interactivity never as innocent as it seems?

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- From communal oral weaving to fixed heroic narratives: Storytelling evolved from collective, mutable tales (pre-Aristotle) to authored, linear plots (Poetics onward), eroding listener agency—critiqued by Benjamin as modernity's isolating fragmentation.
- Performer and audience agency in experimental arts: 1950s music (Stockhausen), Fluxus anti-theater (Higgins), and non-matrixed performances introduced instructions over control, enabling chance-driven variability and real-time navigation.
- Non-linear media and interactive cinema: Paik's tactile sound fields, Hershman's remote-shaped biographies, Weinbren's editable films, and database histories (Terminal Time) transform passive consumption into viewer-assembled narratives.
- Embodied, de-centered meaning-making: Spatial works (Legible City) dissolve hero arcs and author-gods (Barthes/Foucault), exposing Derrida's unstable meanings as choice-driven, contingent constellations beyond linearity.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Rigid hierarchies shatter: Traditional narratives impose true/false, self/other binaries for illusory closure; ergodic forms demand active traversal to unfold multiplicity (Borges' forking paths).
- Rhizomatic networks emerge: Deleuze/Guattari's web-like structures materialize in digital media—Kac's Reabracadabra hacks state Videotexto control into participatory poetry.
- Database logic redefines story: Uncle Roger and Knowbotic South stage exploration as user/database navigation.
- Interactivity's critique: Berkenheger's Bubble Bath weaponizes browser flaws—revealing corporate traps where "freedom" conditions users to systemic aggression.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Interactivity in games emerges from feedback systems between human, machine, and signal. Early technologies such as radar introduced real-time loops of perception, interpretation, and action that later shaped interactive media.
- Games transform the screen from a display into a responsive system. In works like *Tennis for Two*, the visual event exists only through the player's actions, marking a shift from passive viewing to participatory interaction.
- Ethics inside the system. Game art places players inside systems of power—economic, social, linguistic—so that every decision becomes an ethical or political act, not just a move toward victory.
- Play beyond the game. Some works break or suspend the game's logic altogether, turning interactivity into collective, embodied, or unstable play that escapes the imperative to win, progress, or “perform” optimally.

FINAL TAKEAWAYS

1. From meaning as transmission → to meaning as participation. Storytelling begins as a collective act of weaving meaning, where listeners are also future storytellers. Modernity (print, authorship) transforms meaning into something fixed, authored, and consumed.→ The human shifts from co-creator → spectator.
2. The crisis of linear narrative opens the space for interactivity. From Stockhausen to Fluxus to Paik, artists begin to break sequence, script, and hierarchy. Narrative is no longer something you follow — it becomes something you navigate, assemble, and perform.→ The human returns as an active agent inside the structure.
3. Nonlinearity reveals that meaning is not fixed, but contingent. Interactive cinema, installations, and database narratives show that there is no single story — only multiple possible configurations.→ Meaning becomes a result of choices, paths, and perspective, not an inherent truth.

FINAL TAKEAWAYS

4. Digital networks transform narrative into systems of navigation (Net Art) With the rise of networked media, narrative becomes ergodic and database-driven. Users do not follow stories — they traverse systems, assemble fragments, and co-produce meaning.→ But this happens inside infrastructures shaped by power, control, and protocols.
5. Games formalize interactivity as systems of rules, feedback, and consequence. Game art introduces structured interactivity: goals, constraints, rewards. Here, meaning emerges through decision-making under conditions.→ Interactivity becomes a simulation of agency, revealing how freedom operates inside systems.
6. Contemporary interactive art exposes and transforms agency itself. From ethical dilemmas (Brathwaite-Shirley) to systemic critique (Molleindustria) to open-ended play (Triantafyllidis): interactivity is no longer just about choice — it questions: Who decides? Within which system? At what cost?→ We are not simply meaning-makers — we are participants embedded in structures that shape meaning.